

词汇: *humour* 幽默

- 1 Over two thirds of Brits agree that being able to laugh at yourself, or what we call '**self-deprecating humour**', is a defining part of British culture, according to a recent survey by the charity Comic Relief. British **comedian** Sir Lenny Henry says it's not about **putting yourself down**, it's about bringing people together. After years of doing **stand-up comedy**, Lenny says that laughing at yourself is "one of the quickest ways to feel connected to a room full of strangers". But when is it good, and when is it bad, to **make fun** of yourself? Can it be taken too far?
- 2 When a person points out their own flaws in a **light-hearted** way, it can make them seem more human and make others feel comfortable. A 2025 study called 'When Laughter Hurts and Helps' linked the joy of being laughed at with higher **social connectedness**, in other words, a greater sense of belonging to a group. Conversely, the trait 'gelotophobia', or someone who fears being laughed at, has been linked to greater friendship avoidance and lower life satisfaction. Even leaders might benefit from self-deprecating humour. Lecturer at Stanford Graduate School of Business Naomi Bagdonas says that for today's leaders, 'Humour is an **elixir** for trust and an **antidote** to arrogance'.
- 3 **Making light of** negative situations can also be a **coping mechanism**. Imagine you're working on a group project, and something goes wrong. While everyone is panicking and trying to find someone to blame, you say **sarcastically**, "Well, this is going well!" This gives people permission to laugh a bit, and they might feel more positively about the situation. The challenge doesn't vanish, but at least people feel less tense and could feel more able to deal with the situation. A 2024 study published in Europe's Journal of Psychology found that maintaining a **humorous** perspective when things go wrong can lead to greater **resilience**.
- 4 Of course, there's always a balance. While self-deprecating humour can bring people closer and make bad situations less **overwhelming**, it's important that it doesn't come from a place of **bitterness** and self-hatred. It's best to make jokes about yourself only once you've **made peace** with the flaw or mistake you're making fun of.

测验与练习

一、为本文选择总结句。

- a. Laughing at oneself is seen as overall positive.
- b. Laughing at oneself is seen as overall negative.
- c. Laughing at oneself is seen as overall neutral.

二、根据文章内容选出正确的选项。

1. The majority of Brits think laughing at yourself is a key part of British culture, according to a survey.
 - a. True
 - b. False
 - c. Not given
2. The fear of being laughed at has negative consequences.
 - a. True
 - b. False
 - c. Not given
3. Leaders making fun of themselves always leads to good outcomes.
 - a. True
 - b. False
 - c. Not given
4. According to the article, making light of a bad situation...
 - a. removes the challenges.
 - b. makes people feel better.
 - c. makes people feel tense.
5. Self-deprecation is always good.
 - a. True
 - b. False
 - c. Not given

三、用方框中的单词完成对本文的总结。

In the UK, **1)** _____ is popular. The point is to **2)** _____ of yourself in a **3)** _____ way. Research says this type of humour can lead to higher **4)** _____, but it's important not to **5)** _____. First, make sure you have made peace with your flaws to avoid making others feel awkward.

make fun	make peace	put yourself down
social connectedness		bitterness
self-deprecating humour		light-hearted

（答案见词汇表后）

词汇表

self-deprecating humour	自嘲式幽默
comedian	喜剧演员
put oneself down	贬低自己，看轻自己，否定自己
stand-up comedy	单口喜剧
make fun of someone/something	取笑某人或某事
light-hearted	轻松诙谐的，轻松幽默的
social connectedness	社会联结感，与他人的联结感
elixir	万能药，灵丹妙药
antidote	解药，良方
make light of something	对某事轻描淡写，有意淡化某事的严重性
coping mechanism	应对机制
sarcastically	讽刺地，挖苦地
humorous	幽默的
resilience	复原力
overwhelming	令人难以招架的，压得人喘不过气的
bitterness	怨恨，怨愤
make peace with something/oneself	坦然接受，与...和解，释怀

答案

一、为本文选择总结句。

1. **a. Laughing at oneself is seen as overall positive.**

二、根据文章内容选出正确的选项。

1. **a. True.** *Over two thirds of Brits agree that being able to laugh at yourself, or what we call 'self-deprecating humour', is **a defining part of British culture**, according to a recent survey by the charity Comic Relief.*
2. **a. True.** *Conversely, the trait '**gelotophobia**', or someone who fears being laughed at, has been linked to **greater friendship avoidance and lower life satisfaction**.*
3. **c. Not given.** *Naomi Bagdonas says that for today's leaders, 'Humour is an **elixir** for trust and an antidote to arrogance', but such a strong claim is not made.*
4. **b. The challenge doesn't vanish, but at least people feel **less tense** and could feel **more able to deal with the situation**.**
5. **b. False.** *While self-deprecating humour can bring people closer and make bad situations less overwhelming, **it's important that it doesn't come from a place of bitterness and self-hatred**.*

三、用方框中的单词完成对本文的总结。

In the UK, **self-deprecating humour** is popular. The point is to **make fun** of yourself in a **light-hearted** way. Research says this type of humour can lead to higher **social connectedness**, but it's important not to **put yourself down**.